

lower than the OnePlus Two, you can click sharp and good quality images. The 64GB internal storage should be enough for your multimedia content. After having tested endless number of smartphones in the current generation, we can firmly say that you shouldn't spend more than the ₹25-30k mark on smartphones.

In-ear monitors (earphones)

Almost everyone will agree that the earphones packaged along with smartphones are bad. They don't last long and deliver poor quality audio. This motivates you to ultimately go ahead and buy a pair of IEMs, but wait. This category is again riddled with hundreds of options lurking around online and you shouldn't fall for the crappy ones out there. We have covered IEMs across different budgets and if there was one to suggest when the funds are low, the Cowon EK2 has to be the one. Not quite different from the previous



Good quality audio under a tight budget

EM1, the major differences are the ear tips and the tuning that gives you more details in the higher frequency ranges. Yes, there are other worthy options such as the SoundMagic E10S and the JBL Synchros E10, and their price being close to ₹2k, buying the EK2 would be smarter since it sells for around ₹1k. These are the best pair of IEMs you can buy at this budget.

DSLR Cameras

Nowadays you'll find increasingly more people carrying a DSLR camera than ever before but are they making the right buying choices? This category again consists of premium and entry-level variants and you don't really need the features offered on the high-end ones, unless you're a professional. It's debatable whether you're actually going to optimally use the features available on the entry-level segment but considering you



Perfect for entry-level photography

don't want to blow off money, the Nikon D5200 is where your money should go. Priced at around ₹25k, you'll have all the necessary features and control over the camera's manual settings. Compared to the popular choice of picking up the D3200, currently if you look at the price and the advantages of having the swiveling screen, more focus points, greater ISO sensitivity level and a bigger pixel area, the D5200 is a steal. It's smarter to spend less on a camera body and more on lenses, of course if photography is just your hobby otherwise owning a better camera body is always favourable.

Basic and Gaming PC

If you're planning on building a basic computer rig and don't require much computing power, then you can have a wonderful setup at a surprisingly low price of about ₹20k by buying a mini-PC. Of course, you can't expect to run games and work with creative suites on this rig but a normal use-case of internet browsing, working with documents and consuming multimedia content will be a breeze. But if you have higher demands, then you have to spend much more. A budget gaming rig or a creative editing rig has to undergo several compromises in such scenarios. The decision of whether one should buy a micro-ATX motherboard with more features or a simple ATX motherboard with the basic features can be quite daunting. That decision is again dependent on your choice of CPU and hence, the socket type. When it comes to choosing the GPU, the most popular choice would be the NVIDIA's GTX 970. Looking at the local prices, it turns out to be expensive but consid-

ering its lower brethren, the GTX 960, will also serve you well and let you play video games in high and ultra-settings. It's advisable to spend most of your budget on a better performing CPU and GPU while cutting short on the other components. The component choices are intriguing but your head doesn't need to meet a wall. We scratch our heads hard enough every month to come up with a list of such rigs, featured in the "Killer Rigs" section of this magazine. So, our humble suggestion would be to check them out and decide for yourself the most comfortable budget segment.

Laptops

Classified further into dedicated categories, laptops offer the advantage of portability but fall short on performance compared to a desktop. For the same budget, one can possibly build a PC, sometimes a stronger one with the equivalent desktop components. Students usually require a laptop since it's easy to store and carry to college. People on the go always need a laptop to take their work along, becoming an ideal use-case. If you fall under the previously mentioned demographic, only then should you consider buying a laptop. Otherwise, spend your money on a desktop since it gives you a wider and easier scope of future upgradation of components. When buying a laptop for mainstream use-case scenarios, you should be looking around a budget of ₹40-45k. Ultrabooks, convertibles and gaming laptops are all a luxury, and they matter when you're really serious about performance regarding computing power and data transfer speeds. We reviewed the HP Pavillion 15-ab125AX long back and it still remains the best in the mainstream category. The AMD A10-8700P APU combined with 8GB of RAM, 1TB of HDD storage and an AMD Radeon R7 Series M360 GPU, it will take care of all your PC needs and even let you play certain games at lower settings.

Can you live without some gadgets?

Obviously. The gadget categories covered until now belong to the most essential ones. Yet again, you can further make choices of ignoring some categories like if you aren't much keen on clicking photos with a DSLR camera, a smartphone with